



WEIZMANN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE	Faculty of Mathematics & Computer Science הפקולטה למתמטיקה וידען הפחשב
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15/10/2025

Subject: Recommendation letter on behalf of Ortal Dayan

I am writing to strongly recommend **Ortal Dayan** for participation in the *MBZUAI Machine Learning Winter School: Representation Learning & GenAI*. Ortal has been my research assistant for the past two years at the Core AI Research Center at the Weizmann Institute of Science, where we collaborate on a high-risk, high-impact research program focused on explainable AI and the analysis of representation spaces in foundation vision models.

Her work centers on the experimental design and implementation of methods for providing semantic explainability to models such as DINO, CLIP, MAE, and Face ARC. Despite the inherent uncertainty and ambitious goals of our project, she has shown exceptional independence, resilience, and intellectual curiosity. She thrives in exploratory research settings that require both technical rigor and conceptual flexibility.

In addition to her research, she teaches graduate-level courses on the fundamentals of machine learning and deep learning. Her students commend her clarity, dedication, and mentorship - qualities that will allow her to effectively translate insights from this winter school to her teaching and future collaborations.

Her participation in this program will not only advance her professional development but also strengthen the ongoing collaborative project between The **Weizmann Institute** and **MBZUAI**, under which she is currently funded. I therefore support her application with the highest enthusiasm and confidence.

Sincerely,

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